

“special” experts to believe they are the exception to the rule. While others can't beat the simple model, they can.

The problem is that we *all* believe we are better than average. The crushing reality is, “You are less beautiful than you think.”^{[16](#)}

- *Are you a better driver than average? 93 percent of US citizens think so, too.*^{[17](#)}
- *Are you a great teacher? 94 percent of professors think so, too.*^{[18](#)}
- *Are you a better than average stock picker? Of course you are.*

Relegating your decision-making processes to systems requires a massive dose of humble pie. Most—if not all—experts are unable to consume this dish. But to be a better decision maker, we must eat our humble pie. As we have shown in the previous chapters, in order for decision-making to be effective, it must be systematic. And the only systematic thing about humans is our flaws. Therefore, it is best to leave the stock picking to a simple model, which over time, will most likely outperform experts.

Summary

[Chapter 4](#) is about how stories sometimes do not reflect reality. We began with a description of a story created by Melanesian Islanders that failed to bring cargo back to their islands. Next, we discussed how children believe Santa's story (although grownups don't), and how B. F. Skinner's pigeons also created stories around meaningless rituals that preceded the delivery of food pellets. We also discussed meaningless rituals that humans imbue with predictive value, such as the Dallas Cowboys indicator. Even Warren Buffett seems to be selling a story about paying more for high-quality companies that doesn't seem to hold up based on the evidence. We also reviewed other finance stories that seem to make sense, but just aren't true, including the stories that economic growth and lower payout ratios drive higher future stock returns. Because stories are so compelling, we must be on constant guard to prevent ourselves from believing in something that isn't based on evidence.